UNSilencing Slavery

TELLING TRUTHS ABOUT ROSE HALL PLANTATION, JAMAICA

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Published in partnership with the
Center for the Study of Southern Culture
University of Mississippi, Oxford
JAMES G. THOMAS JR., EDITOR

The University of Georgia Press
ATHENS

had renumbered the volumes of the Rose Hall Journal. Vols. 1, 2, and 3 are now vols. 5, 6, and 7, respectively. As I have utilized the original record locator volume numbers since 2014, I have decided not to renumber all of the endnotes to the current record locator volume numbers. However, future researchers at JARD should be aware of this change.

68. This was also the case for the previous white resident enslavers of Rose Hall—John Rose Palmer's great-uncle John Palmer and his wife, Rosa Palmer. They, too, had no children at Rose Hall who would have been breastfed by the enslaved women at Rose Hall.

69. For an adroit and meticulous study of the everyday routines and practices related to enslaved women and reproduction on Jamaican plantations from 1780 to 1834, see Turner, *Contested Bodies*.

70. For more on the historical contextualization and juridical aspects of this law, see Morgan, "*Partus Sequitur Ventrem*."

71. For a comparative example of the workings and lived experiences on a plantation in Jamaica (Mesopotamia Plantation in Savanna-la-Mar, Westmoreland) and a plantation in the United States (Mount Airy Plantation in Virginia), see Dunn, *A Tale of Two Plantations*. For an exceptional study of marriage for enslaved and free Blacks in the nineteenth century in the United States, see Hunter, *Bound in Wedlock*.

72. My thanks to my colleague Professor Dorothy Ko for guiding me to this particular understanding of my book.

73. Cohen, *No Tea, No Shade*, xii.

74. Daisy's birth is noted in JARD, 1B/11/7/40. Panella's birth of a female child is also recorded in JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, Monday, December 22, 1817, vol. 1, fol. 33. This female child is Daisy.

75. In the daily notes for Friday, August 27, 1824, the overseer mentioned that "Kate Delivered of a Still Born child" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, August 27, 1824, vol. 2, fol. 63b).

76. Celia's son Lewis's fatal accident is mentioned in the Rose Hall Journal. When a Rose Hall wagon was in the process of running errands (including transporting shingles from another site to Rose Hall), Lewis was noted as "falling under the Wheel it Crush'd him so much as to cause his death" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 8, 1818, vol. 1, fol. 81). The 1820 slave register notes Lewis's death at the age of twenty-five. Peachy's death is recorded in the journal during the week of March 2–7, 1817, RHJ, March 4, 1818, vol. 1, fol. 43.

77. Here I am invoking what Professor Mame-Fatou Niang posited in the Barnard College #unsilencedpast event with Professor Maboula Soumahoro. Niang pensively noted the "harnessing of silences," the "noisy silences that have haunted me," and the ways "silences can be as eloquent as the noises of the French national narrative." Mame-Fatou Niang, #unsilencedpast Online Series.

CHAPTER 1. In the Wake of the Archive

1. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, Monday, March 17, 1817, vol. 1, fol. 1, and Saturday, November 10, 1832, vol. 3, fol. 140.

2. The following citations are all from JARD, 1B/26, RHJ. For example, on Monday, August 21, 1820, it is noted that Jno. Slater "Removed to Palmyra as Book-Keeper" and Jno. Hallilay "Removed to Rose Hall from P.M." (vol. 1, fol. 166b). On Wednesday, May 1, 1822, "Wm.

Donaldson Employed as second Book keeper" (vol. 1, fol. 254b). On Wednesday, July 30, 1824, "William Townshend Employed as Book keeper" (vol. 2, fol. 59b). Two years later, on Saturday, July 8, 1826, "William Townshend discharged" (vol. 2, fol. 158a). Soon after, on Monday, July 17, 1826, "Employed Charles Skeatsas bookkeeper" (vol. 2, fol. 160a). Three months later, on Friday, October 27, 1826, "Employed Mr. James Marks as bookkeeper" (vol. 2, fol. 173b). On Thursday, September 17, 1829, "Thomas Wilkinson Employed as Bookeeper [*sic*] by the Honble. W. Miller and Mr. R Blair Removed to the [unclear wording]" (vol. 3, fol. 55a). After John Rose Palmer's death in November 1827, William Miller (custos of Trelawny) and William Heath (solicitor) served as receivers of Rose Hall. On April 11, 1832, "Charles Stewart Employed as Bookkeeper" (vol. 3, fol. 121a). On Saturday, August 18, 1832, there is a note at the bottom of the left page stating, "August 16th John Gunson discharged" (vol. 3, fol. 129b). As he is not mentioned as an overseer in the Rose Hall crop accounts, he was probably employed as a bookkeeper.

3. Even though the names of overseers and bookkeepers are infrequently mentioned in the three volumes of the journal, the names of the overseers—William Kerr, James McFarlane, Lawrence Lowe, and Robert Scott—are consistently included in the archival record in Rose Hall's annual crop accounts. In 1822 and 1823 resident owner John Rose Palmer signed the crop accounts for Rose Hall. The crop accounts for most of the years between 1818 and 1832 are housed at JARD, 1B/11/4. These reports specify the number of hogsheads and tierces (wooden barrels) of sugar, as well as hogsheads and puncheons (wooden barrels) of rum produced at Rose Hall, which were then primarily shipped to London and Liverpool (including specific ship names and individuals), with a limited amount being noted as sold in Jamaica and also for consumption at Rose Hall itself. See, for example, the crop accounts signed by Lawrence Lowe as overseer at Rose Hall Estate from 1826 to 1831 (and possibly for some months in 1832) before Robert Scott assumed that position in 1832 (JARD, 1B/11/4/63, 1B/11/4/66, 1B/11/4/68, 1B/11/4/69, 1B/11/4/71, 1B/11/4/72).

4. This format of the journal (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ) remains essentially the same from March 17, 1817, vol. 1, fol. 1, to Saturday, January 17, 1829, vol. 3, fol. 37. The new format included each week's "Distribution of Negroes" and the "Daily Occurrences" on one page (instead of the "Distribution of Negroes" being on the left side of the page and the "Daily Occurrences" on the right side of the page). This shift transpired on Sunday, January 18, 1829, vol. 3, fol. 38, and this new format continued to the end of the journal entries on Saturday, November 10, 1832, vol. 3, fol. 140.

5. In this small group of employed whites at Rose Hall is an alphabetical list of the most recent overseer, Robert Scott, who started in this position on January 5, 1832, as well as the two most recent bookkeepers, Thomas Jessop, who started in this position on August 19, 1832, and Charles Stewart, who started as a Rose Hall bookkeeper on April 11, 1832 (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 3, fol. 130b). It is not clear which of these three white men recorded this journal entry, because, consistent with the other journal entries, the recorder did not sign or initial the page.

6. For more on these laws, see Hall, "Some Aspects." See also Higman, *Plantation Jamaica*.

7. Nicholas Crawford's current book project, entitled "Sustaining Slavery: Food Provisioning, Power, and Protest in the British Caribbean," will offer critical insights about the impact of enslaved people's sustenance and related activism on colonial and imperial policies from the

American Revolution to abolition in the British Caribbean. Thurston, interview with Nicholas Crawford. Provision grounds in Jamaica were often located in rocky plots of land, sometimes in mountainous areas that were positioned at some distance from plantations. Enslaved people cultivated tuberous root vegetables such as cassava, yam, and sweet potatoes, as well as callaloo and various herbs for seasoning and medicinal purposes.

8. Higman, *Slave Populations*, 181–182.

9. The Consolidated Slave Law in Jamaica was not exceptional to this colony. Other British slave colonies, including Barbados and Grenada, also enacted consolidated, ameliorative laws.

10. B. W. Higman notes that the provision grounds for enslaved people at Rose Hall were located at the neighboring Palmyra Plantation (*Jamaica Surveyed*, 236). This would have been the case only after Rose Palmer married John Palmer in 1767, as John Palmer owned Palmyra Plantation. The location of the provision grounds for enslaved people at Rose Hall before 1767 is not clear from the records; some part of the Rose Hall Estate might have been designated for this particular use. In the Rose Hall Journal, overseers also indicated that enslaved people worked provision grounds in the mountains, as was often the case at other Jamaican plantations. In 1828 one overseer noted, "Negro Day No. 24. in their Grounds in Sunderland Mountains" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, Saturday, January 10, 1829, vol. 3, fol. 36). Although there is no extant plan or map for Rose Hall Estate before abolition, in 1838 William Miller, one of the receivers of Rose Hall Estate, arranged for a survey of Rose Hall; the survey was conducted by Richard Wilson. Part of the plan is reproduced in Higman, *Jamaica Surveyed*, 235, fig. 8.11.

11. In November 1826 an overseer noted, "Negro Day No. 15," reflecting a recognition of the 1826 Jamaican law regarding twenty-six of these days per year (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, Saturday, November 4, 1826, vol. 2, fol. 174). In June 1828 a overseer started tracking and noting the number of "Negroes Days" throughout the year. He noted, "Negro Day No. 1" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, Saturday, June 28, 1828, vol. 3, fol. 6).

12. A number of scholars have examined the critical role of provision grounds for both enslaved people and enslavers in Jamaica and throughout the Caribbean. See, for example, Parry, "Plantation"; Marshall, "Provision Ground"; Sheridan, "From Chattel"; and Higman, *Slave Population and Economy*. Ahmed Reid revisits previous hypotheses and proposes a direct relationship between labor productivity and provision grounds, specifically that "on estates where the enslaved population grew provisions, the level of labor productivity was high relative to those estates where no such incentive was present." As a result, he argues, "an increase in provision acres led to an increase in the number of hogsheads produced per slave" (Reid, "Sugar, Slavery," 169–170). Also see DeLoughrey, "Yam, Roots, and Rot." Invoking the significance of the provision grounds in Jamaica, a recent cookbook pays homage to the women of Jamaica and the Caribbean who worked those provision grounds during slavery and presents a range of contemporary vegetarian recipes in this spirit; see Rousseau and Rousseau, *Provisions*.

13. "Grasscutters" as a separate category are sometimes listed under the gangs. The categories for first gang, second gang, and third gang are always at the top of the columns of duties/positions. The first and second gangs are often grouped together with a combined total number for enslaved people working in these gangs. Also, due to the overseers reporting the numbers, there are journal entries that list the three gangs combined in one total number, and they are listed as "The Gangs" or "The Three Gangs."

14. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 1b.

15. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 1a.

16. For more on meanings of mortuary and mourning beliefs, practices, and politics in eighteenth- and early nineteenth-century Jamaica, see Brown, *The Reaper's Garden*.

17. A range of illnesses are recorded in the documents, for example, "affection of the brains," dysentery, venereal disease, tuberculosis (referred to as "consumption" at that time), worms, yaws, palpitation of the heart, dropsy, and poisoning from ingesting substances, especially parts of the nightshade plant. In addition to these diseases, other listed reasons for death include "natural decay," "old age," "debility," and "visitation of God."

18. See historian Stephanie E. Smallwood's critical analysis of slave trade–related ledgers and notes on African captives in the marginalia of these ledgers in *Saltwater Slavery*.

19. Edward Mountague served as receiver of Rose Hall Estate in 1817. When Rose Hall owner John Palmer passed in 1797, the estate was inherited by his two sons, James and John, who resided in England. In 1817, in their absence, Edward Mountague was charged with submitting the slave register for Rose Hall for 1817. By the next year, both of John Palmer's sons had died, and John Rose Palmer, John Palmer's grandnephew, inherited Rose Hall Plantation and the neighboring Palmyra Plantation. From John Rose Palmer's arrival at Rose Hall in 1818, as the new plantation owner and receiver, until his death in November 1827, he endorsed these triennial returns for Rose Hall Plantation. Following John Rose Palmer's death, William Heath and the Honorable William Miller served as the receivers for the final 1829 and 1832 returns. See "Edward Mountague"; "William Heath"; and "Hon. William Miller (attorney)."

20. NA Kew, T71/202. The 1817 list of enslaved people at Rose Hall was also dated as officially confirmed on September 16, 1817. Between Isaac's passing on March 19, 1817, and the date of the 1817 slave register on June 28, 1817, two other enslaved people had died. One of them was "J.O." The first letter is somewhat blurred but is probably a J. J.O. is recorded as dead on Monday, April 28, 1817. At the bottom of the page of the "Distribution of Negroes" for the week of April 28 to May 3, J.O. is described as dying "of natural decay being an Invalid for many years." There is no indication about whether J.O. was categorized as a man or woman, and there is no note about whether J.O. was African born or Creole. The total number of enslaved people at Rose Hall is changed in this entry from 154 (minus 1) to 153. The adjustment in the number on the "Distribution of Negroes" page, however, includes a reduction of one in the total number of people working in the combined first and second gangs. As a result, J.O. most likely worked primarily in the cane fields in either the first or second gang (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 3a). The next week of the journal (May 5–10) is missing. The next journal entry is for the following week (May 12–17), and the total number of enslaved people beginning on Monday, May 12, is 152, indicating that another enslaved person probably died during the week of May 5. There are no other deaths of enslaved people recorded in the journal from May 12, 1817, until the first Rose Hall slave register dated June 28, 1817, and the total number of 152 enslaved people remains constant during this time period.

21. Nadia Ellis's conception of "queer" in her article on Jamaican dancehall provides a useful, generative way of conceptualizing the fluidity that I would suggest we consider in holding this imaginative space for enslaved persons: "*Queer* functions for me as a signifier of sexual and gender nonnormativity, a break in the line of gender. This may include erotic exchanges between people of the same gender, but is not limited to them. It is very often bound up with the homo-

erotic, though it need not be sexual. *Queer* emphasizes practice, action, not categorical state. *Queer* shifts, it moves, it does not rest. It names a practice, it names a moment, it names a person, sometimes all three simultaneously. It might name a different practice, a different person in another moment. Crucially, in my analysis *queer* does not depend on knowing in any assured way what a person feels about his or her sexual orientation. Indeed, it refuses the sense that 'orientation' tells us anything concrete or stable about who we are and what we do. It *does* depend on there being a discursive field, a social matrix, that defines normative sexual and social practices against which the queer stands" ("Out and Bad," 12).

22. There are other racial- and color-centered terms that are not utilized in either the Rose Hall Journal or the slave registers for Rose Hall but that appear in other plantation and general records during this time (e.g., mustee, mustiphini, quinteroon, and octoroon). While touring the Caribbean and in his notes about his time in Jamaica, Dr. Richard Robert Madden described the "various classes of free persons of colour." In *A Twelvemonth's Residence in the West Indies* he includes definitions for sambos, mulattos, quadroons, and mestees (89).

23. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 3, fols. 2–4.

24. This item is entitled "List of Slaves on Rose Hall Estate Served with Clothing by the Honble. William Miller, This 18th August, 1832." One of the subsequent reprintings in 1952 (most often housed in libraries) mistakenly identifies the list for the Rose Hill Estate (instead of the Rose Hall Estate). Shortened citations to Shore, *In Old St. James*, refer to the 1952 edition and its "List of Slaves on Rose Hall Estate, August 18, 1832," plus the page number.

25. Osnaburg fabrics, named for the city of Osnabrück, Germany, were worn by both enslaved people and poor working-class whites in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries. In the eighteenth century, it was made from linen fibers, and in the nineteenth century, it was primarily made from cotton. Osnaburg fabric was also utilized for industrial purposes. Today it is still used for upholstery and draperies due to its durable qualities. Peniston/Pennystone is a coarse heavy woolen cloth from England worn from the sixteenth to the nineteenth century. It presumably also was named in relation to a town—Penistone in southern Yorkshire in England. Penistone was known for its native sheep, which produced a strong, durable wool, with coats from this area sometimes referred to as Penistones.

26. The madras/bandana silk cloth was initially from India. However, the silk Indian version was not utilized for enslaved people. Instead, a cotton version of this style was produced in England and then exported to Jamaica. This madras/bandana cloth was utilized for blouses, dresses, and head wraps. Although this fabric had long been associated with slavery (or country folk generally) in Jamaica, when Jamaican icon Louise Bennett-Coverley ("Miss Lou") began wearing this cloth in the 1960s in a purposeful manner for her performances, she celebrated this cloth as an item to be reclaimed as part of Jamaican cultural history. Her incorporation of this cloth shifted perceptions of it, and this transformed its integration into other Jamaican cultural performances as a visible, tangible marker of Jamaican cultural and national history. For one examination of Jamaican clothing and style, see McKenzie, "Jamaican Ethnic Dress."

27. An English ell equals 1.25 yards; however, the Scottish and Flemish ells equal slightly less yardage. This fabric could have been calico, which was another cloth often allocated to enslaved people in the Caribbean, or some other kind of mixed inexpensive fabric.

28. Camp, *Closer to Freedom*.

29. At the bottom of the 1832 list of males at Rose Hall is a note: "N.B.—Jack, to the Estate

of Mr. Kerr, a Negro." Although I have included Jack here, it is not absolutely clear whether at the time of the list Jack was an enslaved person at Rose Hall working at Mr. Kerr's estate, a "hired negro" of Mr. Kerr's working at Rose Hall, or an enslaved person involved in some other arrangement. I have included Jack in the total number of enslaved people, as he appears on this 1832 clothing allowance list. However, I have no other descriptive information regarding Jack's country of origin or duties or other distinguishing characteristics.

30. Although the journal and my study are focused on Rose Hall Plantation, it is important to note that this enslaved community probably extended to Palmyra Plantation (a nearby plantation owned by John Palmer). Even before John Palmer married Rosa Palmer, enslaved people at both plantations might have developed relationships based on kin and kith. There are several references to Palmyra in the Rose Hall Journal. Although there are triennial slave registers for Palmyra, there is no extant plantation journal for Palmyra, so it is not possible to reconstruct and confirm details of individual enslaved people's lives at Palmyra and their connections to enslaved people at Rose Hall.

31. The term "fictive" kin/kinship has long been utilized in scholarly work. Instead of describing these connections as "fictive" kinship relationships, I suggest utilizing "expansive" kinship relationships. These relationships between people who were not related by blood or marriage did not make them contrived or fictitious in any way.

32. See, for example, the arguments presented in Goveia, *Slave Society*; Besson, *Transformations*; Patterson, "From Endo-deme to Matri-deme"; Higman, "The Slave Family"; and Craton, "Changing Patterns." For one example of an excellent study of the complicated relationships and marital structures between African Americans in bondage and in freedom, see Hunter, *Bound in Wedlock*.

33. For example, the Queering Slavery Working Group, co-organized by professors Jessica Marie Johnson at Johns Hopkins University and Vanessa Holden at the University of Kentucky, "was formed to discuss issues related to reading, researching, and writing histories of intimacy, sex, and sexuality during the period of Atlantic slavery. Guided by the question, 'What would it mean to Queer Slavery?,' the group seeks out queer encounters in slavery's archive. Operating across page and screen, the Queering Slavery Working Group brings discussions happening in black queer studies, queer of color studies, and histories of enslaved and free people of African descent across the diaspora into lurid and profane contact" ("About, Queering Slavery Working Group"). Also see Aidoo, *Slavery Unseen*.

34. NA Kew, T71/214, fol. 33. Although not done consistently, the placement of names on the triennial slave registers often reflects the particular timing of births and deaths at Rose Hall; the names listed at the top are associated with the first part of the time period for the register and additional names following a sequential pattern.

35. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 2, fols. 33b, 52b.

36. As noted earlier, over the course of the journal, from 1817 to 1832, the notes related to the passing of enslaved people at Rose Hall appear more frequently in the marginalia of these weekly reports.

37. Renny, *An History of Jamaica*, 172. Shipmates of the Middle Passage are referenced in a number of sources. In *An History of Jamaica* in 1807, Robert Renny, Esq., states: "A *ship-mate* is one of their most endearing appellations; and they who have been wafted across the Atlantic ocean in the same vessel, ever after look upon each other as brethren: So natural is it for partners in misfortune, to become dear to each other!" (ibid., author's emphasis). See also Herman Bennett's critical work regarding the close relationships developed between shipmates during the Middle Passage and how these connections extended to the selection of godparents for enslaved Africans and free Blacks in colonial Mexico (*Colonial Blackness*).

38. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544.

39. It is extremely difficult to read the journal entry for the week of April 29, 1822, due to the worn, weathered condition of the page. In fact, the "Distribution of Negroes" side of the page (on the left) is mostly blank as a result of the damage to this page. The "Daily Occurrences," on the right side of the page, is somewhat legible. It is in the notes for Saturday, May 4, that someone is mentioned as dying of old age. It is clear that the name is a short one and part of the reason that it could well be Jreen/Green. In addition, given the older enslaved people at Rose Hall in that year and the timing of their recorded deaths before or after this date, it is most likely that the person who was noted as dying "of old age" on Saturday, May 4, 1822, is Jreen/Green (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 254b).

40. NA Kew, T71/202, fols. 544, 543, 544, 540, 541.

41. In the 1817 slave register, Janet is listed as Janet and Creole (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543). However, she is listed as Jannet and African in the 1828 list for clothing allowance in the Rose Hall Journal, as well as in the *Old St. James* 1832 clothing allowance list (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 3, fol. 3; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110). As she is listed in both of the final clothing allowance lists as African, I have included her as part of the group of African-born women at Rose Hall.

42. It is important to note his position as a watchman at Rose Hall, as he had absconded multiple times from Rose Hall in 1820, 1826, and even in 1832.

43. The position of "driveress" was not exceptional on Jamaican sugar plantations. See Richard S. Dunn's discussion of the positions of enslaved persons (including driveress) at the Mesopotamia sugar plantation in Jamaica (*A Tale of Two Plantations*, esp. chap. 4, "'Dreadful Idlers' in the Mesopotamia Cane Fields," 131–180).

44. Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–109.

45. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 102; JARD, 1B/11/7/40, fol. 160ba.

46. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 2, fol. 52b; JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

CHAPTER 2. Bondage, Birthing, and Belonging at Rose Hall Plantation

1. Morgan, *Laboring Women*, 40.

2. Ibid.

3. Vasconcellos, *Slavery*, 8.

4. Ibid., 9.

5. Ibid.

6. Ibid.

7. Ibid., 16.

8. Ibid., 10. As Vasconcellos also states, "The nature of girls' work became more complex as planters increasingly linked gender to reproductive potential, and enslaved girls' work summarily took on a reproductive component as a result" (ibid.).

9. I invoke this notion of African-born women in Jamaica being a new "Eve" of the Creole population in the Caribbean in conversation with historian Jennifer L. Morgan's analysis of how some European male travelers described African women as experiencing pain-free childbirth. Morgan includes an excerpt from English-born Jamaican planter and historian Edward Long's statement in his 1774 text *History of Jamaica* that Black women "delivered with little or no labour. . . . Thus they seem exempted from the course [*sic*] inflicted upon Eve and *her daughters*" (Long as quoted in Morgan, *Laboring Women*, 189, Morgan's emphasis). Morgan asserts: "If African women gave birth without pain, they somehow sidestepped God's curse upon Eve. It they were not her descendants, they were not related to Europeans and could therefore be forced to labor on England's overseas plantations with immunity" (ibid.). As she affirms, "In the case of England's contact with Africa and the Americas, the crisis in European identity was mediated by constructing an image of pain-free reproduction that diminished Africa's access to certainly and civilization, thus allowing for the mass appropriation that was the transatlantic slave trade" (ibid., 190).

10. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 22, 1817, vol. 1, fol. 33.

11. As previously mentioned, Julina is noted as Creole in the 1817 slave register and then as African in the 1832 clothing allowance list (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110). Parts of the 1828 list for clothing allowance have been torn or have deteriorated over time, and in the list (arranged by age), Julina's name would have been included at the very bottom of one of these torn-out/deteriorated pages. As a result, I do not have that additional list in order to confirm whether Julina was African-born or Creole. Jannet is also described as Creole in the 1817 slave register (name spelled in 1817 as Janet). However, she is categorized as African in the 1828 list for clothing allowance in the Rose Hall Journal and in the Old St. James 1832 clothing allowance list (name spelled as Jannet) (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 3, fol. 3; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110). As she is listed in both of the clothing allowance lists as African, I have included her as part of the group of African-born women at Rose Hall.

12. Names of enslaved people that included "Sambo" or "Mulatto" were not particular to Rose Hall. Instead, these monikers emerge in other plantation records.

13. Doshy's name is also spelled as Doshey in the Rose Hall Journal.

14. See, for example, Morgan, *Laboring Women*; Turner, *Contested Bodies*; and Morgan, "Slave Women."

15. See, for example, Bush, "Hard Labor"; Bush, "The Family Tree." See also Schiebinger, "Agnotology" (on the poinciana tree as an abortifacient in the Caribbean), and Fett, *Working Cures*, regarding herbal knowledge and medical practices of enslaved women in the southern United States.

16. Turner, *Contested Bodies*, 203.

17. Denaud, "Renegade Gestation." Denaud is a doctoral candidate in Africana studies at Brown University. She is currently working on her dissertation, "At the Vanishing Point of the Word: Blackness, Imperium, and the Unnameable War."

18. See, for example, Craton, *Searching*; Higman, *Slave Population and Economy*; Morgan, "Slave Women"; Forster and Smith, "Surviving Slavery"; Vasconcellos, *Slavery*; and Turner, *Contested Bodies*.

19. For a thoughtful, comprehensive analysis of the myriad factors shaping the shifting notions, values, and strategies associated with enslaved motherhood, pregnancy, childbirth, and child-rearing in Jamaica from the late 1700s into the early decades of the 1820s, see Turner, *Contested Bodies*.

20. Ibid., 170–171.

21. Whether or not enslaved children were named in the journal shortly after birth, my close analysis of the records enabled me to identify and name all of the enslaved children if their individual names appeared in at least one of the archival documents. For a detailed discussion of neonatal complications and the precarity of enslaved newborns, as well as enslaved mothers' strategies and responses in their pregnancy, childbirth, and child-rearing practices in Jamaica, see chap. 5, "'Dead before the Ninth Day': Struggles over Neonatal Care," in ibid., 151–181.

22. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, March 27, 1824, vol. 2, fol. 41b.

23. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

24. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, September 9, 1832, vol. 3, fol. 132a, and September 23, 1832, vol. 3, fols. 133a, 134a.

25. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, August 27, 1824, vol. 2, fol. 63b. In only a couple of years, another child of Kate was recorded in the 1826 register; her name is Leddy. The 1826 register notes her age as six months. The next slave register, of 1829, lists Leddy's death at eight months. These are the only children named as being Kate's children at Rose Hall.

26. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, July 2, 1823, vol. 2, fol. 4b. This is the only child of Gift/Giss who appears in the extant records.

27. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, September 28, 1825, vol. 2, fol. 120a. Gift/Giss's death is also recorded in JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

28. There is some disagreement among scholars about the extent to which enslavers in Jamaica consistently recorded information about stillborn infants and infants who passed within days and weeks after their birth. See, for example, Higman, *Slave Population and Economy*. In his work, historian Kenneth Morgan argues that "it is likely that spontaneous miscarriage (before twenty-eight weeks of pregnancy) and stillbirths (after twenty-eight weeks) rather than calculated abortions were responsible for high rates of foetal loss. Indeed, what were alleged as self-induced abortions might equally have been spontaneous miscarriages: on plantations it would have been difficult to distinguish these two causes of prematurely terminated pregnancy" ("Slave Women," 246).

29. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 545; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

30. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

31. At the bottom of the "Distribution of Negroes" in the journal for the week of June 1, 1818, the overseer noted that "Dorinda deliv'd of a male ch'd, Morris." In the column for Monday, June 1, 1818, the total number of enslaved people is listed as 153 with the addition of one and the new total of 154 (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 56a). Morris's birth and death are listed in JARD, 1B/11/7/40, fol. 160. Morris's death and related circumstances are not included in the pages of the Rose Hall Journal. Although Morris's name is recorded at the time of his birth, the recording of names of newborns in the Rose Hall Journal is not consistently included.

32. John's birth and death (JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74).

33. In the "Daily Occurrences" for the week of April 15, 1822, the overseer's notes for Tuesday, April 16, 1822, include the statement "Mary Delivered of a Male Childe." As in most of the notations regarding births of enslaved children at Rose Hall, John's name is not mentioned (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 252b).

34. Matilda, NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543.

35. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109.

36. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Sylvia's birth, June 2, 1831, vol. 3, fol. 102. She is listed as one year and one month old in the 1832 slave register, NA Kew, T71/223, fol. 91.

37. NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

38. NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215. Given the timing of the deaths of Marcus and Maxwell, their deaths were probably recorded in the missing pages of the Rose Hall Journal in 1827 and 1828.

39. NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

40. Mary's age is listed in NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544.

41. JARD, 1B/11/7/40, fol. 160ba; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109.

42. JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

43. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109 (listed under the name "Jennie," a possible misspelling of "Jemmie").

44. JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a; and see JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding John's birth (though unnamed in the journal), August 29, 1820, vol. 1, fol. 167b.

45. NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215. Note regarding Allick's death in JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, February 24, 1832, vol. 3, fol. 117b.

46. Allick's birth is recorded in the journal on Monday, September 4, 1820; it is noted that "Dorinda delivered of Male Child Sept 3d" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 168b). The journal entry for Monday, January 8, 1821 notes, "Allick, young child of Dorinda's died of Yaws" (vol. 1, fol. 186b). Although a number of Dorinda's other children's names are included in the notations of their respective births in the journal, this is not the case for Allick or Surry. The entry for Wednesday, December 12, 1821, states, "Dorinda delivered of a Male Child" (vol. 1, fol. 234b). This is in reference to Surry's birth. The overseer mentioned on Tuesday, February 19, 1822, that "Surry died suddenly Verdict Visitation of God" (vol. 1, fol. 244b). Both Allick's and Surry's births and deaths are recorded on the same page in 1823 (JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74).

47. Eliza's birth (JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a) and Eliza's death at four (JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a).

48. Sam is included in the 1817 slave register as age eleven, negro, Creole, and son of Dorinda (NA Kew, T71/218, fol. 542) and in the 1832 list of enslaved people as Sam (Christian name Sam Ellis), age twenty-five, negro, Creole, a cooper, of good disposition, with a sore leg, and valued at £100 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107).

49. Anthony is included in the 1817 slave register as age seven, negro, Creole, and son of Dorinda (NA Kew, T71/218, fol. 542) and in the 1832 list of enslaved people as Anthony (Christian name Jas. Ellis), age twenty-one, negro, Creole, a muleman, of good disposition, able and healthy, and valued at £100 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107).

50. William is included in the 1817 slave register as age two, negro, Creole, and son of Dorinda (NA Kew, T71/218, fol. 542) and in the 1832 list of enslaved people as Wm Kerr, age sixteen, negro, Creole, a cattleboy, able and healthy, and valued at £100 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109). He is also noted as a runaway at that time.

51. Venus is listed as age one, negro, Creole, and daughter of Dorinda (JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a) and in the 1832 list of enslaved people as Venus (Christian name Eliza Stennet), age six, negro, Creole, the hogmeat gang, of good disposition, healthy, and valued at £40 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113). Venus's birth is noted along the left margin of the "Daily Occurrences" for the week of July 11, 1825: "1825, July 3rd Dorinda Delivered of a Female Child Named Venus" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 2, fol. 109a).

52. John is listed as three weeks old, negro, Creole, and son of Dorinda (NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215), as well as in the 1832 list of enslaved people as John (Christian name John Rose Palmer), age two, negro, Creole, not at work, of good disposition, able and healthy, and valued at £30 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107). John's birth is noted in the journal along the left margin for the weekly entry of May 31–June 6: "Dorinda delivered of a Male Child Named John on the 1st" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 3, fol. 47b).

53. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 3, fol. 72a.

54. At the very beginning of the journal, for the week of March 17–22, 1817, there is a category titled "Doctress & Gardner" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, vol. 1, fol. 1). The title "doctress" remains within the listed duties until November 3, 1817 (fol. 26). The following week, the week beginning on November 10, 1817, the category changes to "Doctor & Gardner" (fol. 27). On Monday, March 16, 1818, it changes to "Doctorman" and then back to "Doctor" (fol. 45). In February 1820, "Gardner" is deleted, and only "Doctor" remains for this category (fol. 140). In March 1820 the category changes to "In Hospital and Attendants" (fol. 146). This category remains until the end of the journal in 1832. No specific person is named as the doctress or doctor between 1817 and 1820.

55. As historian Tara Inniss explains, midwifery during slavery was a contested racial, gendered, and classed profession in the British Caribbean. Enslaved and free midwives, as Inniss notes, "received monetary payments for their attendance of enslaved women. Enslaved midwives were one of the few enslaved, female-dominated occupational groups in plantation society to receive cash payments from estate managers. . . . In addition to small sums of money, enslaved midwives were also given non-monetary consideration for their work. It is unclear, however, to what extent enslaved midwives received cash payments exclusively for the unique service they offered" ("'Any Elderly,'" 45). See Paugh, *The Politics of Reproduction*, 122–153, for one example of the politics of midwifery in the Caribbean, with specific references to the midwives at the Newton Plantation in Barbados (primarily between 1770 and 1804). Given Paugh's description and discussion of the midwives at Newton Plantation (including the Afro-Barbadian midwife Doll), it is clear that definite differences existed in terms of the benefits extended to midwives in different circumstances across plantations in the British Empire. Neither Doll's nor Dorinda's experiences should be utilized as exemplary of midwifery on a Caribbean plantation. See Turner, *Contested Bodies*, for a thoughtful and extensive analysis of midwives and the practice of midwifery in Jamaica from the 1780s to the 1830s.

56. For an insightful discussion of childbirth practices and the critical roles of pregnant enslaved women and midwives in these practices and processes, see Turner, *Contested Bodies*, especially chap. 3, "When Workers Become Mothers, Who Works? Motherhood, Labor, and Punishment," 68–111, and chap. 4, "'Buckra Doctor No Do You No Good': Struggles over Maternal Health Care," 112–150.

57. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, April 22, 1830, vol. 3, fol. 72a. This incident with Dorinda is also briefly mentioned in Vasconcellos, *Slavery*, 35.

58. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 11, 1830, vol. 3, fol. 88b. This sentence ends with the ini-

tials L.L., most likely for Lawrence Lowe, who was overseer at Rose Hall from 1826 to 1831 (and possibly for some months in 1832), before Robert Scott assumed that position. Elizabeth Palmer's baby was born on December 5 and died on December 8. As with the previous examples noted earlier in this chapter, the passing of Elizabeth Palmer's newborn in 1830 (who died within the first nine days of life) remains unrecognized and unnamed in the 1832 slave register.

59. Her two children included in the 1832 clothing allowance list were Othello (fifteen in 1832) and Hope (four in 1832) (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109, 112–113). Another son, Robert, who was born in October 1832, is not on that clothing allowance list; instead, his birth is included in the journal and the 1832 slave register (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Robert's birth, October 26, 1832, vol. 3, fol. 138a; NA Kew, T71/223, fol. 91).

60. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Cecelia's birth (unnamed in journal entry), February 5, 1822, vol. 1, fol. 242b; and JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a.

61. JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a.

62. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Lydia's birth on May 3, 1824, vol. 2, fol. 47.

63. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding death of Juno's child (unnamed in journal entry), January 6, 1826, vol. 2, fol. 134.

64. NA Kew, T71/223, fol. 91.

65. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Susan's death, September 26, 1831, vol. 3, fol. 111b. Her death should also have been included in this 1832 slave register, but she is not included in the death section.

66. NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

67. Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

68. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

69. Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

70. Henry's birth and death at the age of two are both listed in the same register (NA Kew, T71/218, no folio number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215). Henry is classified as negro in the birth section but then reclassified as mulatto in the death section. It is possible that he was misclassified at birth and then correctly classified at the time of his death at two or vice versa.

71. Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

72. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a.

73. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111.

74. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543; and T71/223, fol. 91.

75. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

76. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109.

77. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, JANUary 6, 1819, vol. 1, fol. 85a.

78. Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109.

79. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544.

80. NA Kew, T71/202, fols. 543, 542.

81. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Doshy's death, November 8, 1823, vol. 2, fol. 21; and JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

82. NA Kew, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

83. A number of entries of the Rose Hall Journal are missing and unreadable (especially due to the deterioration of the pages) for this time period, so the recording of Exeter's death is not included in the extant pages of the journal.

84. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Rebecca's death, July 15, 1828, vol. 3, fol. 9a, and her death at sixty-three is included in NA Kew, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

85. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 545.

86. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

87. Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

88. Augusta was thirty-eight years old in 1817 and is noted as having died at age fifty-two in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). Augusta was the mother of five children: Ben, son who is seventeen in 1817 and thirty-one in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107); Pitt, son who is fourteen in 1817 and twenty-eight in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107); Brown, daughter who is eleven in 1817 and twenty-eight in 1832—probably closer to twenty-six in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 545; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111); Clarinda, daughter who is five in 1817 and nineteen in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 545; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113); and Oliver, son who is two in 1817 and sixteen in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109). Although Augusta and her five children were still alive in 1832, in the 1829 slave register Augusta's granddaughter Charity—Brown's daughter—dies at three months old (NA Kew, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215).

89. African-born Polly was forty in 1817 and then dead at the age of forty-nine. Polly's son Scipio was fifteen in 1817 and twenty-nine in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107).

90. African-born Rachel is sixty-two in 1817; however, she died a few years later in 1822 at the age of sixty-six (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544). Rachel's death of old age is noted in JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, Monday, June 17, 1822, vol. 1, fol. 261b; and in JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a. Her son Peter is eighteen in 1817, and he remained alive at age thirty-two in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 541; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107).

91. African-born Stella is thirty-two in 1817 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544). The overseer recorded her death in the journal on March 16, 1818, and her death at the age of forty-three is also noted in the 1829 slave register (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Stella Williams's death, May 3, 1829, vol. 3, fol. 45b, in the marginalia; NA Kew, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215). Stella's daughter Flora is twelve years old in 1817 and twenty-six in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111).

92. Creole Bessy, also known as Bessy McLaren, was twenty-seven years old in 1832. She is noted as mulatto, and in 1832 she was a washerwoman (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). She had two sons described as quadroon: Richard / Richard Mabon, who is one in 1823 and nine in 1832 (JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109), and Robert, who is one in 1829 and three in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109).

93. Creole Chance was thirty-three years old in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). Her one daughter, Frances, is one in 1820 and twelve in 1832 (JARD, 1B/11/7/40, fol. 160ba; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113).

94. Creole Cynthia was twenty-five years old in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113). Her one daughter, Lizzy, Elizabeth / Elizabeth Chambers, is described as sambo and noted as six months old in the 1826 slave register; Lizzy Elizabeth is noted as six years old in the 1832 list (JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113).

95. Delia was forty-four years old in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). Her son Quaco is thirteen years old in 1817 and twenty-seven in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107).

96. Creole Dianna is described as negro and five years old in 1817, and in 1832 she is described as sambo and nineteen years old (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 545; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113). Her son James was born in January 1831, and he is noted as one year and five months old in the 1832 list (NA Kew, T71/223, fol. 91).

97. When Hope died in December 1828 at the age of fifty-six, both of her adult children were still alive (Hope's death due to "debility" noted in JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 7, 1828, vol. 3, fol. 28b). In fact, they both remained alive in 1832—Juno is forty in 1832, and George is thirty-nine in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107, 110–111). Hope, however, also lived to witness two of her daughter Juno's children die between the ages of one and three.

98. Jeany/Jeanie is thirty-four in 1832 (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 7, 1828, vol. 3, fol. 28b; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). She was the mother of two young daughters: Bess, two and a half in 1826 and seven in 1832, and Suckey/Suckie, six months old in 1826 and five in 1832 (JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113).

99. Maphe is fifty-nine in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 108–109). She was the mother of one daughter, Mary, who is twenty-three in 1817 and thirty-seven in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111).

100. Nancy is a fifty-four-year-old field worker in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). She was the mother of three daughters: Kate, twenty-four in 1817 and thirty-eight in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111); Frankey/Frankie, eighteen in 1817 and thirty-two in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111); and Matilda, eighteen in 1817 and thirty-two in 1832 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111). Frankey and Matilda may well have been twins; if not twins, they were born quite close in time to each other.

101. Memmy Jun was fourteen in 1817 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544). Isaac's name is not included in the notation in the Rose Hall Journal regarding his birth. The journal entry states, "Mimmy deliver'd of a Male Child" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, April 13, 1820, vol. 1, fol. 148). Memmy Jun is also called "Mimmy" in the journal.

102. JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a.

103. The journal notes that "Panella delivered of a [missing word—probably "Female"] Chd Nd Daizy" (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 22, 1817, vol. 1, fol. 33). Panella is listed as twenty-three years old in 1817 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544).

104. JARD, 1B/11/7/40, fol. 160ba.

105. Panella's death of consumption noted in JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, June 15, 1822, vol. 1, fol. 260b. For information on Daizy, see Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

106. See Vasconcellos, *Slavery*, for an extended discussion of different kinship groups and "slave villages" on Jamaican plantations that might have served to assist young enslaved children who had been separated from their biological mothers and extended family networks.

107. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, note regarding Daphney's death on May 12, 1818, vol. 1, fol. 53.

108. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544.

109. Fanny's age recorded in NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544. Fanny's death of dropsy (or edema) noted in JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, May 5, 1821, vol. 1, fol. 202.

110. Rosannah is listed as thirty in 1817 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544). Her death is recorded in JARD, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

111. Mary James is noted as fourteen in 1817 (NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544). She is listed as twenty-eight in 1832 (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111).

112. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544.

113. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 543; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111.

114. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 106–107.

115. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 544; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

116. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 545; and Shore, *In Old St. James*, 112–113.

117. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a; NA Kew, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

118. For works on the particular experiences of enslaved girls and women, including sexual violence, in the Caribbean and in the United States, see, for example, Beckles, *Natural Rebels*; Berry, *Swing the Sickle*; Berry, *The Price*; Bush, *Slave Women*; Camp, *Closer to Freedom*; Cooper Owens, *Medical Bondage*; Fett, *Working Cures*; Fuentes, *Dispossessed Lives*; Glymph, *Out of the House of Bondage*; Mair, *The Rebel Woman* and *A Historical Study*; Millward, *Finding Charity's Folk*; Morgan, *Laboring Women*; Morissey, *Slave Women*; and Turner, *Contested Bodies*. Although focused on the sexual violation and exploitation of enslaved girls and women here, recently scholars have begun to explore more thoughtfully the sexual violation of enslaved boys and men. For two critical books in this area, see Aidoo, *Slavery Unseen*; and Foster, *Rethinking Rufus*.

119. Some attention has been focused on one particular Jamaican enslaver, especially his detailed records of his sexual exploitation and violation of enslaved girls and women. Indeed, one historian tallied the number of sexual acts that this enslaver described in his diaries and how many women were mentioned in these acts, including a calculation regarding the average number of acts of sexual violation by this enslaver in different periods of his life. See Burnard, *Mastery*, 156. A necessary intervention to Burnard's analysis regarding the rapes of enslaved women by Thistlewood has been offered by Vermeulen, "Thomas Thistlewood's."

120. Although the records do not specify the white fathers associated with Sarah Spence's family, it is telling that Sarah's daughter Bessy's surname was McLaren. Robert McLaren was one of the overseers at Rose Hall (and possibly also partly at Palmyra Plantation). From 1803 to June 1808, McLaren submitted the annual crop accounts report for Rose Hall until a new overseer, Thomas Forsyth, was hired in that position. McLaren also submitted the annual crop accounts for Palmyra Plantation in 1821 (JARD, 1B/11/4/56, fol. 41). It is possible that Bessy's father was Robert McLaren. Bessy's son Robert's Christian name was listed as "Lawrence Low." Lawrence Lowe was one of the overseers at Rose Hall Plantation. The invocation of this name may have reflected a biological association between Lawrence Lowe and Robert.

121. Recent works on multiracial people and interracial sex in the British Empire during slavery include Newman, *A Dark Inheritance*; and Livesay, *Children of Uncertain Fortune*.

122. James, *The Book of Night Women*, 156–158. For an especially discerning examination of

this scene, as well as the multifarious layers of Lilith's character, see the recent work of literary scholar Kaiama L. Glover, *A Regarded Self*, 188–217. Although a novel, the venue for *The Book of Night Women* is Montpelier Plantation, an actual sugar plantation in Jamaica also located, like Rose Hall, in the parish of St. James. Marlon James weaves layers of complexities of slavery and sexuality within this novel. Lilith, the protagonist and the character raped in this excerpt from the novel, is not only the child resulting from the rape of her enslaved mother and a white overseer but also engaged in a complicated relationship with another white overseer (for whom she has a daughter after he is killed during a slave revolt). For an excellent historical study of Montpelier Plantation, see Higman, *Montpelier, Jamaica*.

123. Vasconcellos, *Slavery*, 44.

124. Ibid., 44–45. Enslaver Thomas Thistlewood is the usual example, given his documented sexual abuse of enslaved girls and women in Jamaica.

125. For a couple of examples, see Crowley, "Naming Customs"; Higman, "The Slave Family"; Handler and Jacoby, "Slave Names"; Craton, *Searching*; Thornton, "Central African Names"; Burnard, "Slave Naming Patterns"; and Vasconcellos, *Slavery*, 63–67.

126. For a more extensive discussion about Yoruba names, see Babalola and Alaba, *A Dictionary*. Also see Barber, *I Could Speak*.

127. For more on Akan naming practices, see Agyekum, "The Sociolinguistic."

128. The selection of the eighth day for Yoruba naming ceremonies is often connected partially to Islamic influences on Yoruba cultural practices. It is important to note that there are also some Yoruba groups that have naming ceremonies on the sixth day after the baby's birth. Depending on whether twins are fraternal or identical, naming ceremonies for twins may also occur on the seventh, eighth, or ninth day after birth.

129. For a detailed discussion of some of the historical and linguistic elements of names of enslaved people in Jamaica focusing on Mona and Papine Estates, see West, "Slave Names Memorialized."

130. See Agyekum, "The Sociolinguistic," 214.

131. NA Kew, T71/202, fol. 542.

132. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, October 30, 1824, vol. 2, fol. 73.

133. JARD, 1B/11/7/85, fol. 155a.

134. Miranda's name is spelled Maranda in this list (Shore, *In Old St. James*, 110–111).

135. Elder Cecelia was also described as the mother of Liddy (listed as twenty-five in 1817 and dead in 1823 at age thirty), Smith (listed as twenty-three in 1817 and thirty-seven in 1832), Harry (listed as twenty-one in 1817 and thirty-five in 1832), and grandmother of Pastora (Liddy's daughter listed as eleven in 1817 and twenty-five in 1832), grandmother of North (Liddy's son listed as six in 1817 and twenty in 1832), Parish/Paris (Liddy's son listed as four in 1817 and dead in 1823 at age four).

136. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, February 5, 1822, vol. 1, fol. 242b.

137. JARD, 1B/11/7/66, fol. 74a.

138. JARD, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215.

139. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 7, 1828, vol. 3, fol. 28b.

140. See Vasconcellos, *Slavery*, for more on the range of duties of the "children's gang" (30–33).

141. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, May 3, 1824, vol. 2, fol. 47.

142. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, January 6, 1826, vol. 2, fol. 134.

143. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, December 8, 1818, vol. 1, fol. 81.

144. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, May 11, 1829, vol. 3, fol. 46a.

145. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, March 6, 1832, vol. 3, fol. 118b.

146. JARD, 1B/11/7/40, fol. 160ba.

147. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, April 13, 1820, vol. 1, fol. 148.

148. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, October 28, 1828, vol. 3, fol. 23a. The word "poisonous" is blurred and misspelled in the journal, and the exact name of the fish may have been included but was not legible.

149. In the 1829 slave register, Patrick is listed as dead at the age of fifty-six (JARD, T71/218, no fol. number noted on document; and JARD, 1B/11/7/100, fol. 215).

150. JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, September 8, 1818, vol. 1, fol. 69.

151. Although I have emphasized naming at Rose Hall as a process primarily involving enslaved people, there may have been instances of white denizens naming enslaved people or influencing the naming processes at Rose Hall as an extension and demonstration of their authority, power, and entitlement. The overseers note, in the margin, that on June 1, 1829, Dorinda gave birth to a son (JARD, 1B/26, RHJ, June 1, 1829, vol. 3, fol. 47b). This son is later identified in the 1829 slave register as John. In the 1832 clothing allowance list, John's Christian name is noted as John Rose Palmer. As resident enslaver John Rose Palmer passed in 1827, this child was probably given this name in memory of him. However, it is entirely unclear whether Dorinda or other enslaved members of the Rose Hall community decided on that name or whether that honor was realized without any particular consideration of Dorinda, John's father, or any other family members. As both Dorinda and John are identified as negro in the records and as John Rose Palmer passed before John was conceived, John Rose Palmer was certainly not the biological father of John. However, the Christian name of Bessy/Betsy's son Robert may offer additional information regarding his paternity. Bessy/Betsy, also noted as Betsy McLaren in the records, is described as a thirteen-year-old mulatto in the 1817 slave register and also in the 1832 clothing allowance list as twenty-seven years old with the primary duty of a washerwoman. She was the daughter of Sarah (often referred to as Sambo Sarah in the journal). Bessy/Betsy's listed children at Rose Hall are Richard Mabon (listed as a one-year-old quadroon in the 1823 slave register and nine in the Old St. James list in 1832) and Robert (listed as one in the 1829 slave register and three in the Old St. James list in 1832). Richard's primary duty in 1832 is listed as "overseer's house," and due to his age, Richard is "not at work." In the *Old St. James* list of 1832, Robert's Christian name is noted as being "Lawrence Low." Given that Robert was identified as a quadroon and with this Christian name, it is certainly feasible that his father was one of Rose Hall's white overseers, Lawrence Lowe.

CHAPTER 3. "Till Shell Blow"

1. Senior, *Shell*, 51–52. In her "Author's Note," Jamaican writer Olive Senior states that she wanted to complete this book "by 2007, the 200th anniversary of the abolition of the slave trade by Britain." She highlights that the "huge labour force required by the sugar cane plantations was the driving force behind the slave trade by which millions of Africans were captured and brought in chains to forced labour across the sea. . . . The sugar plant itself is a hard shell